joined his vision for freedom in Cold War Berlin with similar goals for the domestic home front of the United States, presented together in a shared "New Frontier" of progress.[2]

Robert Kennedy also shared his observations of the Wall as a site and a symbol of repression. "This surely is the meaning of the Berlin Wall," he proclaimed, "that ugly mass of concrete brick and barbed wire which lies across the heart of your city, like a medieval instrument of torture." He added, "They wall their people in. We set our people free." Toward the close of his speech, Kennedy shared a moment of reflexivity, identifying with the Berlin Wall by recognizing his own nation's racial divides and legacies of repression: "For a hundred years, despite our protestations of equality, we had, as you know, a wall of our own—a wall of segregation erected against Negroes. That wall is coming down."[3]

In his remarks, Robert Kennedy located Cold War Berlin as both an outpost and extension of the divided landscapes of American culture. He acknowledged the Berlin Wall in reference to hostile and entrenched racial divides within the United States, a form of division that both preceded and remained upheld by his own administration. He relayed the shared characteristics of division; by placing the wall of segregation both in the past ("we *had*") and the present ("That wall *is* coming down"), he demonstrated the uneven lag of social change. His speech at the Free University stands out not only for the delivery of "Cold Warrior" rhetoric in a divided Berlin, but also for his confirmation of the contradictions of Cold War culture and the limits of U.S. freedom principles set against the backdrop of the Berlin Wall. In this speech, Kennedy drew on the interplay between physical and social lines of division, and the past and the present. He laid bare the fact that his nation was fighting for global freedom abroad while practicing an incomplete form of democracy at home.[4]

Despite the *New York Times* quoting "a wall of our own" in its coverage of Robert Kennedy's trip, his phrase lacked both the immediate resonance and monumental afterlife of his brother's later "Ich Bin ein Berliner," which dramatically asserted the president's symbolic citizenship of the divided German city.[5] In the early years of the Berlin Wall, both Kennedys asserted their direct identifications with the people of divided Berlin, simultaneous to the civil rights movement and domestic questions of racial equity, access, and citizenship. Democracy promoted abroad, in the shadow of the Wall, ran counter to the embedded practices of discrimination inscribed into U.S.